UNIT 38.1 · LEVEL C1

Cleft sentences – it-clefts

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 Which sentence is an it-cleft?

a) Tom lost the keys.
b) What Tom lost was the keys.
c) It was Tom who lost the keys.
d) Tom is the one losing keys.

2 It was my sister _____ called me last night.

a) who **b)** whose **c)** where **d)** what

3 It was not until midnight _____ the power came back.

a) than **b)** as **c)** what **d)** that

4 Which sentence emphasises the place?

a) It was last year that they got engaged.
b) It was in Rome that they got engaged.
c) They got engaged in Rome last year.
d) It was they who got engaged in Rome.

5 Was _____ your brother who left the door open?

a) there **b)** it **c)** he **d)** that

6 It was the cost _____ put us off, not the location.

a) who **b)** whom **c)** when **d)** that

7 It was only when I got home _____ I noticed the missing wallet.

a) that **b)** what **c)** which **d)** why

8 It _____ my parents who paid for the trip.

a) were **b)** are **c)** was **d)** have

9 It was the manager himself _____ I spoke to.

a) what **b)** whose **c)** where **d)** that

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10 Why do speakers use an it-cleft?

a) To put focus on one part of the sentence
b) To turn a statement into a question
c) To describe actions in the past only
d) To avoid using a main verb

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 It was Sarah _____ suggested the idea.

12 It was the rain _____ ruined our picnic.

13 It was not until 2015 _____ they moved abroad.

14 It is on Friday _____ we leave for Paris.

15 It was _____ who left the lights on, not me.

16 _____ was in Spain that we spent our holiday.

17 It was Anna and Tom _____ organised the party.

18 It wasn't the food _____ I disliked, but the service.

19 Was it you _____ called me at midnight?

20 It's your attitude _____ worries me.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **it / was / who / Anna / broke / the vase**

_____

22 **that / it / was / the / noise / woke / me / up**

_____

23 **not / it / was / until / that / noon / she / woke**

_____

24 **was / it / Tom / who / called / you**

_____

25 **at / that / it / the / was / airport / we / met**

_____

26 **it / who / my / was / told / grandmother / me / the / story**

_____

27 **wasn't / it / money / that / the / mattered**

_____

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28 **is / it / food / the / that / I / most / miss**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the word that completes the it-cleft.*
It was my uncle _____ called us last night.
Options: **who** / **what** / **where**

30 *Choose the best word.*
It was not until we landed _____ we turned on our phones.
Options: **that** / **when** / **what**

31 *Choose the verb form.*
It _____ my cousins who organised everything.
Options: **was** / **were** / **being**

32 *Complete the question.*
_____ it your sister who answered the phone?
Options: **Was** / **Did** / **Has**

33 *Choose the linking word.*
It was the heat _____ made us leave early.
Options: **that** / **who** / **whom**

34 *Choose the best word.*
It was in this café _____ my parents first met.
Options: **that** / **what** / **who**

35 *Choose the pronoun.*
It wasn't Jack _____ broke it, but Ben.
Options: **who** / **which** / **what**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each it-cleft to the element it emphasises.

1. It was Ben who paid. _____
2. It was in May that we moved. _____
3. It was at the beach that we met. _____
4. It was because of the rain that we left. _____

A. A time
B. A reason
C. A person
D. A place

37 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. It was the noise _____
2. It was my aunt _____
3. It was not until Monday _____
4. Was it you _____

A. who left this note?
B. that kept me awake.
C. who sent the parcel.
D. that I heard the news.

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38 Match each answer to the question it gives.

1. It was Lena who won. _____
2. It was in Rome that we met. _____
3. It was last week that he left. _____
4. It was the cost that worried us. _____

A. What worried you?
B. When did he leave?
C. Where did you meet?
D. Who won?

39 Match each incorrect sentence to its mistake.

1. It were my friends who came. _____
2. It was Ana which called. _____
3. There was Tom who called. _____
4. It was not until noon than he left. _____

A. Wrong relative pronoun
B. Wrong opening word
C. Wrong linking word
D. Wrong verb form

40 Match each normal sentence to its it-cleft.

1. Kate found the wallet. _____
2. We met in Paris. _____
3. The delay annoyed me. _____
4. She called at noon. _____

A. It was the delay that annoyed me.
B. It was Kate who found the wallet.
C. It was at noon that she called.
D. It was in Paris that we met.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 It was Maria which called me yesterday. Correct word: _____

42 It were my parents who paid for it. Correct word: _____

43 It was in 2010 who we moved to Canada. Correct word: _____

44 It is the weather what makes me tired. Correct word: _____

45 There was my boss who called me at six. Correct word: _____

46 It was not until I arrived than I realised.
Correct word: _____

47 It was Lucy whom won the prize. Correct word: _____

48 It's John and Mary who is getting married.
Correct word: _____

49 It was last night what the storm hit. Correct word: _____

50 It was because of the traffic why we were late.
Correct word: _____

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Cleft sentences – it-clefts

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** It was Tom who lost the keys.	An it-cleft = It + be + focus + that/who clause.
2	**a)** who	Use who when the focus is a person.
3	**d)** that	Pattern: It was not until ... that ...
4	**b)** It was in Rome that they got engaged.	The place comes right after It was.
5	**b)** it	In questions, be comes before it: Was it ... who ...?
6	**d)** that	Use that when the focus is a thing.
7	**a)** that	After a focused time clause, use that.
8	**c)** was	It stays singular, even before a plural noun.
9	**d)** that	That can introduce the clause after a person or thing.
10	**a)** To put focus on one part of the sentence	It highlights the information after be.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**who** (or: that)	Use who for a person.
12	**that** (or: which)	Use that for things.
13	**that**	Pattern: It was not until ... that ...
14	**that** (or: when)	Focus on time: It is ... that ...
15	**he** (or: him)	Formal choice after It was: he.
16	**It**	The subject of an it-cleft is It.
17	**who** (or: that)	Use who for people.
18	**that** (or: which)	Use that for things.
19	**who** (or: that)	Use who for the person in focus.
20	**that** (or: which)	Use that for things.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**It was Anna who broke the vase.**	It + was + focus + who clause.
22	**It was the noise that woke me up.**	Focus on the noise.
23	**It was not until noon that she woke.**	Pattern: not until ... that.
24	**Was it Tom who called you?**	Question form: Was it ... who ...?
25	**It was at the airport that we met.**	Focus on the place.

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26	**It was my grandmother who told me the story.**	Focus on the person.
27	**It wasn't the money that mattered.**	Negative it-cleft.
28	**It is the food that I miss most.**	Focus on the food.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**who**	Use who for a person.
30	**that**	Not until ... that.
31	**was**	It + was, even with a plural noun.
32	**Was**	Question: Was it ... who ...?
33	**that**	Use that for things.
34	**that**	Focus on the place + that.
35	**who**	Use who for a person.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	It was Ben who paid. – A person; It was in May that we moved. – A time; It was at the beach that we met. – A place; It was because of the rain that we left. – A reason The focus comes right after It was.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	It was the noise – that kept me awake.; It was my aunt – who sent the parcel.; It was not until Monday – that I heard the news.; Was it you – who left this note? Choose who for people and that for things and times.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	It was Lena who won. – Who won?; It was in Rome that we met. – Where did you meet?; It was last week that he left. – When did he leave?; It was the cost that worried us. – What worried you? The focus answers the question.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	It were my friends who came. – Wrong verb form; It was Ana which called. – Wrong relative pronoun; There was Tom who called. – Wrong opening word; It was not until noon than he left. – Wrong linking word Check the verb, pronoun, opening and linker.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	Kate found the wallet. – It was Kate who found the wallet.; We met in Paris. – It was in Paris that we met.; The delay annoyed me. – It was the delay that annoyed me.; She called at noon. – It was at noon that she called. Move the focus after It was.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**who** (or: that)	Use who (or that) for a person, not which.
42	**was**	It is singular: It was.
43	**that**	Who is only for people; use that.
44	**that** (or: which)	Use that, not what, in it-clefts.
45	**It**	An it-cleft starts with It, not There.
46	**that**	Pattern: not until ... that.
47	**who** (or: that)	A subject needs who, not whom.
48	**are**	The verb agrees with John and Mary: plural.
49	**that**	Use that, not what.

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50	**that**	After the focus, use that.

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